

Applying to college

Once a teen has decided on a course of study, it's time to start applying and getting familiar with the information each college requires—closing dates, for example. Most colleges require a personal statement, and drafting it early gives teens time to consider carefully what they want to say. Some colleges also interview prospective students.



△ Open houses

Visiting colleges and attending open houses can help teens decide where they want to go. Talk to undergraduates there to get a sense of their experience.



△ Applications

Well-written, engaging, and original applications cover what teens hope to gain from the course, and what they'll bring to the college as a student.

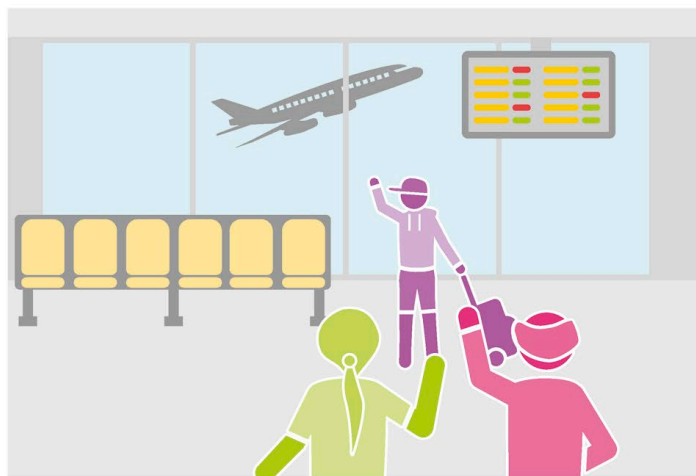


△ Housing

There are usually lots of housing options, such as rented rooms or apartments, or accommodations on campus.

Studying abroad

Some students have the opportunity to study at college abroad through an exchange program. Others study for their entire degree abroad. This can be a great opportunity for a teen to experience another culture, learn a language, and add an international dimension to their resume.



Student finance

Many students take out loans and therefore need to budget carefully. Some students also take on a part-time job to help with their costs. Students can apply for any scholarships or awards that might be associated with their course, but competition for these is usually fierce.



△ Life skills

Parents often worry that their teen won't look after themselves at college, but the experience offers them a chance to learn vital skills, such as budgeting, staying healthy, and time management.